



Spreading the Word

Before spending money on costly marketing campaigns, consider using low-cost methods of promoting your products or services yourself to generate sales.

Telling the world

Marketing your products and services is essential in order to attract sales. While your budget may not allow for professional campaigns at first, there are steps you can take to spread the word at minimal cost. Known as “organic marketing,” this approach simply requires your time, energy, and creativity.

Organic marketing involves any means of getting your message out to potential customers and clients. This can include writing a blog, attending local fairs, handing out samples of your product, or posting your business details on free online directories.

This approach is less direct than conventional advertising, so the benefits may be slow to materialize. However, research shows that more than 70 percent of consumers ignore paid-for advertising and have greater trust in “word-of-mouth” messages, triggered by customer experience, as they appear to be more authentic. As such, even when you can afford to undertake more traditional marketing techniques, organic methods are well worth continuing.

Creative approaches

The primary aim of marketing is to promote sales, and should work in conjunction with your public relations activities, (see pp.136–137). When using organic marketing, be creative, and use as many methods and channels as possible, to target potential customers and clients. However, always ensure your approaches are consistent with your brand and company values.

USE YOUR CONTACTS

- › **Ask friends and family** to talk about your products and services to everyone they know, both on- and offline.
- › **Approach business** contacts and former colleagues to help promote your venture.

REPRESENT THE BUSINESS

- › **Attend industry events**, where you can talk about and show your products or services. Share your details and build contacts.
- › **Participate in community events**, such as fairs and shows, to meet potential customers and clients. Demonstrate what you offer.